

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

1. Before human beings rebelled against God, creation was in . . .
 - a. a state of shalom.**
 - b. a state of sin.
 - c. a state of redemption.
 - d. a state of restoration.

2. Choose all that correctly describe the effects of sin.
 - a. Sin separates us from God.**
 - b. Sin introduced suffering and chaos in nature.**
 - c. Sin gives us independence and special knowledge.
 - d. Sin breaks our relationships with other people.**
 - e. Sin corrupted us so that it is now part of our nature.**
 - f. Sin causes great setbacks but can be overcome through our effort.
 - g. Sin makes us unable to redeem ourselves.**

3. Choose all relationships that were broken by Adam and Eve's rebellion.
 - a. relationship between humans and God**
 - b. relationship between humans and self**
 - c. relationship between humans and angels
 - d. relationship between humans and the serpent
 - e. relationship between humans and creation**
 - f. relationship between humans and others**
 - g. relationship between humans and divine knowledge

4. God initiated his mission of redemption through the family of . . .
 - a. Abel.
 - b. Moses.
 - c. Abraham.**
 - d. Joseph.

5. Choose all that describe Israel's role in God's mission.
 - a. Israel was to be an exclusive community of religious elites.
 - b. Israel was to be a God-shaped community.**
 - c. Israel was to show the world what right relationship with God looked like.**
 - d. Israel was to be a flawless nation for God to work through.

6. The Jews' responsibilities while in exile included . . .
 - a. remaining faithful to God in the midst of pagan cultures.**
 - b. seeking the welfare of the nations where they had been taken.**
 - c. fighting for their liberation and vengeance on their enemies.
 - d. trusting in God's promises to restore his people and bring them out of exile.**

7. The hopes of the Jewish people during the second temple period included . . .
 - a. the inclusion of the Gentiles in the kingdom of God.
 - b. deliverance from their oppression.**
 - c. the establishment of shalom.**
 - d. the arrival of God's kingdom.**
 - e. a humble messiah who would forgive enemies.
 - f. the forgiveness of sins.**
 - g. a messiah who would lead them to victory.**

8. Choose all that describe how the Jews responded to the pressure of hellenization during the second temple period.
 - a. Pharisees called for strict adherence to the Torah and oral traditions.**
 - b. Hellenists called for giving alms to the poor and executing traitors.
 - c. Essenes fled to the desert to draw close to God in isolation.**
 - d. Sadducees aligned themselves with the rich and powerful rulers.**
 - e. Judeans helped Judah Maccabee conquer Rome.
 - f. Zealots made violent attempts to cast off Roman oppression.**

9. Choose all that describe the Incarnation.
 - a. A human child was conceived by the Holy Spirit.**
 - b. Jesus became the first human to reach divine consciousness.
 - c. The eternal God became fully human while remaining fully God.**
 - d. God merged with humanness, becoming half man and half God.
 - e. A great and wise, but not divine, teacher was born.

10. The words used by the Bible to describe the church is . . .
 - a. *thiasos*, referring to a religious cult.
 - b. *ekklesia*, referring to a public assembly.**
 - c. *heranos*, referring to a private religious meeting.
 - d. *parakaleo*, referring to a mentoring group.

11. Which best describes the gospel?
 - a. The gospel message is the good news that we are basically good but oppressed by sin.
 - b. The gospel message is primarily about social change.
 - c. The gospel messages promises rewards in heaven but no transformation on earth.
 - d. The gospel message reconciles us to God, renews and transforms our hearts, and then transforms the relationships all around us.**

12. Choose three biblical words for wrongdoing.
 - a. repression
 - b. transgression**
 - c. iniquity**
 - d. interdependency
 - e. sin**

13. Which key verse articulates the concept of *imago Dei*?
 - a. Genesis 1:1
 - b. Genesis 1:27**
 - c. John 3:16
 - d. Colossians 2:13–15
14. Which act in the biblical metanarrative answers the question, “What is the solution to what’s wrong with the world?”
 - a. Act 5: Restoration Initiated
 - b. Act 6: Restoration Accomplished
 - c. Act 3: Redemption Initiated
 - d. Act 4: Redemption Accomplished**

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

- F** 15. Transgression means to miss the goal. sin
- T** 16. The kingdom of God is the just and peaceful rule of God over all creation.
- T** 17. The people of God, known as *the bride of Christ*, will dwell and rule with God in the new creation.
- F** 18. The words “And you, who were dead in your trespasses and the uncircumcision of your flesh, God made alive together with him, having forgiven us all our trespasses, by canceling the record of debt that stood against us with its legal demands” are found in John 3:16.
Colossians 2:13–15
- T** 19. The biblical story is for all people at all times.
- F** 20. The synagogue is primarily defined not as just a building but as the community of people who have trusted Christ for salvation. church
- F** 21. The idea that human beings are made in the image of God is found in Act 1:
Creation— God’s Good World, which is recorded in Genesis 3–11.
Genesis 1–2
- F** 22. John gave a basic outline of the gospel message in Genesis 12:1–3. John 3:16

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points.]

Fill in the missing word to complete each statement.

23. **Iniquity** refers to crooked, wicked, or perverse behavior.
24. Ultimately, the biblical metanarrative is centered around the person of **Jesus**.
25. The eternal hope of the church is Jesus' personal and visible return from heaven to Earth, often called the **second coming**.
26. Three aspects of *imago Dei* include **rule**, **relationship**, and **resemblance**.
27. When a Christian explains the good news that Jesus is Lord and that through him salvation and forgiveness are available to all, this process is called sharing the **gospel**.
28. When Christians treat other people with dignity, respect, and value for that person's intrinsic worth as a human being, they are applying the biblical concept of **imago Dei** to how they interact with others.
29. The Jewish people faced pressure under **hellenization**, a movement to spread Greek culture throughout conquered lands.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions.

30. List the names of the first three acts of the biblical metanarrative and where they are found in the Bible.
Act 1: Creation—God's Good World (Genesis 1–2)
Act 2: The Fall—Sin and Its Consequences (Genesis 3–11)
Act 3: Redemption Initiated—Israel (Torah, Prophets, Writings)
31. List the three words that the Hebrew term *shalom* expresses.
peace, harmony, wholeness
32. Briefly explain the importance of metanarratives.
Metanarratives help us make sense of the world. They direct the way we think and act. They also help us connect our individual stories to a larger story.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

33. Explain how the biblical metanarrative affirms both human dignity and human brokenness.
Possible answer: The biblical metanarrative affirms human dignity by explaining that humans are a special creation of God and are made in the imago Dei. That means all humans have dignity and value given by God. The metanarrative also affirms the brokenness of humans as we have rebelled against God and failed to love him and others. Sin separates us from God, and we are unable to save ourselves. It also breaks our relationship with ourselves and others. Though human beings are broken, they still have dignity and worth because they are made in the image of God.

34. Explain four elements included in the serpent's temptation of Adam and Eve.
Possible answer: When the serpent tempted Adam and Eve to eat of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil, this included several elements. One is the idea that God was holding out on them. The serpent made it seem like God had bad intentions. The second is disbelief in God's warning that they would die. The serpent made the consequences seem minor. The third is the promise of being their own authority, like their own little gods. The serpent implied that they would be equals to their Creator. Finally, the serpent's temptation implied a gain of independence and special knowledge. He told them the decision wasn't foolish, but that it was wise.

35. How does the gospel bring reconciliation to all our relationships?
Possible answer: Because the gospel restores us to a right relationship with God, that affects all our other relationships as well. When we are reconciled to God, we are forgiven and declared righteous. The Holy Spirit also begins transforming us into the image of Christ.
 We are reconciled to ourselves as God restores us to who he intended for us to be. We are reconciled to others as we learn to love them through the transforming love of Christ. We are also reconciled to nature, as we steward it and care for it as God intended.